

Sadly, his efforts were not appreciated by audiences in Brazil, so he traveled to Paris, hoping to make his name as a composer. This marked a turning point in his career—he found success there and met musicians from all over the world, among them guitarist Andrés Segovia, who commissioned a study for guitar from Villa-Lobos, *Chôros*, which featured the musical styles of the Brazilian *chorões*. Villa-Lobos wrote many studies and pieces for Segovia over the years.

Return to the homeland

On a visit home in 1930, the outbreak of a revolution prevented Villa-Lobos from returning to Paris. By the end of that year, Getúlio Vargas had seized power, declaring an end to the Old Republic. Villa-Lobos was appointed director of the Superintendência de Educação Musical e Artística in São Paulo, and until 1945 organized concerts and provided patriotic compositions for the populist leader.

In 1936, he left his wife for Arminda Neves d’Almeida, who became his muse and partner for the rest of his life. His music, however, continued to become more propagandist and nationalist, and to appeal to a mass audience that rejected any form of Modernism. But this did bring him the recognition he sought in his home country, and prompted a prolific period of creativity, especially after Vargas was ousted. Democracy restored, Villa-Lobos traveled to the US and Europe, where he gained an international reputation.

By the mid-1950s, after Vargas’s suicide, demand for Villa-